

Shayan Shakeri

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Toronto, Canada

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

AI Research Engineer focused on running and building evaluations that surface where frontier models fail. At BMO's AI Centre of Excellence, built a deterministic agent eval pipeline from hundreds of synthesized inputs that detected systematic risk-downplaying bias in a GenAI tool serving \$200B+ AUM; co-founder of Merlyn Labs, developing hard-to-game VLM judges and shipping published eval research (8th place, Stanford BEHAVIOR-1K Challenge) while employed full-time. Strong SWE fundamentals across Python, C/C++, PyTorch, and JAX.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Model Evaluation

Eval Infrastructure

Agent Scaffolds

Misalignment Detection

Hard-to-Game Evaluation

Technical Writing

Systems Debugging

Python / PyTorch / JAX

WORK EXPERIENCE

BMO AI Centre of Excellence

Sep 2024 - Present

AI Research Engineer Toronto

- Built a **deterministic agent eval pipeline** from hundreds of synthesized inputs to detect misaligned model outputs at scale: eval infrastructure that makes misalignment detection repeatable.
- Uncovered systematic bias to downplay investment risk in a GenAI tool serving **\$200B+ AUM** wealth management by running the model across synthesized eval tasks.
- Building a graph-based agentic system answering complex multi-hop relational queries across bank client data: agent scaffolding over an LLM.

Merlyn Labs

Aug 2025 - Present

AI Researcher & Co-Founder Toronto

- Developing **VLM judges** that score model rollouts into dense rewards designed to **resist gaming**: adversarial, hard-to-game evaluation.
- Placed **8th in Stanford's BEHAVIOR-1K Challenge**; identified proprioceptive collapse as a critical failure mode and published a technical report, LessWrong analysis, and an arXiv benchmark critique, communicating rigorous findings to technical and broad audiences.
- Open-sourced a flow-matching VLA integration for RLinf, building the eval and RL-training infrastructure for the BEHAVIOR-1K suite in OmniGibson.

Epineuron Technologies

May 2021 - Aug 2022

Biomedical & Electrical Engineering Co-op Mississauga

- Designed and assembled PCBs and authored validation protocols (IEC 60601-1, ISO 13485) for PeriPulse, an FDA Breakthrough-designated device now in multi-national clinical trials.

PROJECTS

Stanford BEHAVIOR-1K Challenge

8th Place, Standard Track

Ran and evaluated frontier VLA policies at scale (**10,000+ demonstrations over 22 tasks**); diagnosed failure modes through rigorous ablations (proprioception masking, chunked vs temporal execution) and published the findings as a technical report and LessWrong analysis.

EDUCATION

M.Eng, MIE - AI & Robotics, University of Toronto

Sep 2024 - Apr 2027

Coursework: Deep Learning, Reinforcement Learning, AI Applications in Robotics, Healthcare Robotics.

B.Eng, Engineering Physics Co-op, McMaster University

Sep 2018 - Jun 2023

Dean's Honour List. Coursework: Computational Multiphysics, Quantum Computing, Numerical Methods, Signals & Systems.

SKILLS

ML & AI: Model Evaluation, Eval Infrastructure, Agent Scaffolds, Misalignment Detection, Hard-to-Game Evaluation, LLM Fine-tuning, Agents, RL, Python, C/C++, PyTorch, JAX

Robotics & Simulation: VLA Models, OmniGibson, MuJoCo, Flow Matching, Sim2Real, ROS2